Access: Denied

A 5-Challenge Puzzle Chain - Visual Summary

Final Project
LMC 2700 - Spring 2026
by Ryan Nguyen & Daniel Lee

1. *Unscramble*

What you see:
Newspaper byline:
"By NEKLAF AUHSOJ"

How to solve:
Reverse each name letter-by-letter.

Answer:
JOSHUA FALKEN

Action:
Type into terminal: reveals the hint "look next to the ReadMe.TXT"

2. *Riddle*

What you see:
Riddle of the Day: "shift your direction..."

How to solve:
Find the cipher key in the Notes app.

Answer:
Atbash Cipher (A=Z, B=Y, ... M=N)

Action:
Use this key to decode the next clue in the mini-terminal.

3. *Cipher*

What you see:
Readme line in the mini-terminal:

XIRXFRGH

How to solve:
Apply Atbash:
X>C I>R R>I X>C
F>U R>I G>T H>S

Answer:
CIRCUITS

Action:
Type into terminal
-> opens the circuits puzzle.

4. *Circuit Puzzle*

What you see:
3x3 toggle grid
+ dim lightbulb
+ hidden answer

How to solve:
Toggle into X-pattern:
ON OFF ON
ON OFF ON
ON OFF OFF

Answer:
TICTACTOE (revealed under bulb)

Action:
Type into terminal
-> 7-board pigeon cipher autoplays.

5. *Pigeon Cipher*

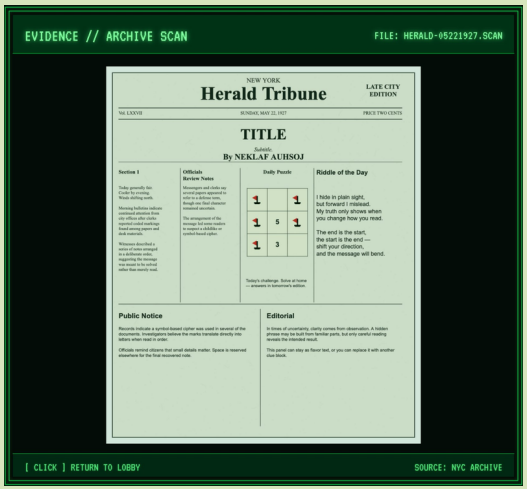
What you see:
7 tic-tac-toe boards autoplay one at a time (2.5s each).

How to solve:
Each O/X position maps to one letter using the Notes key.

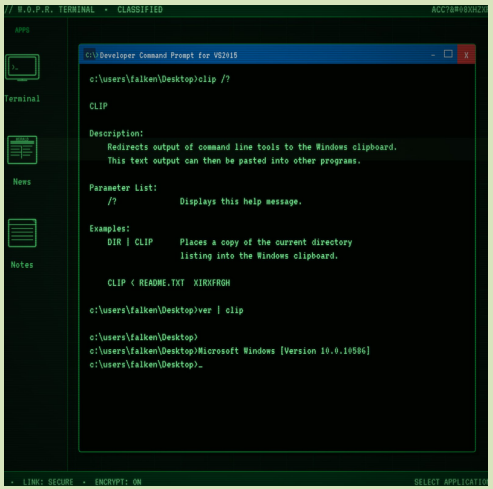
Answer:
DEFCONV

Action:
Type into terminal
-> SYSTEM DISABLED
You win!

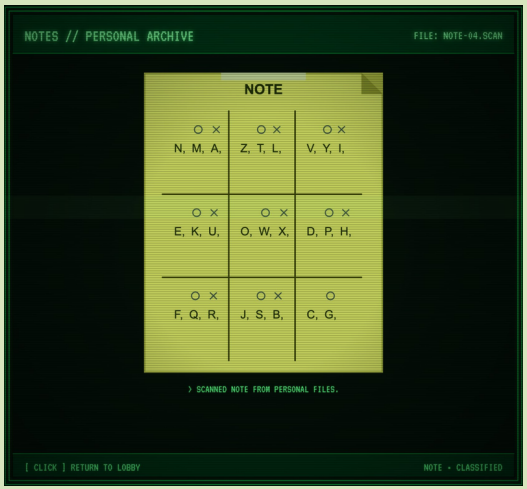
From the Game:



The Newspaper - source for Ch. 1 & 2



The Mini-Terminal - source for Ch. 3



The Cipher Key Note - used in Ch. 2 & 5